

Natalus primus, Cuban Greater Funnel-eared Bat

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Citation: Mancina, C. 2016. *Natalus primus*. *The IUCN Red List of Threatened Species 2016*: e.T136777A22032828. <http://dx.doi.org/10.2305/IUCN.UK.2016-1.RLTS.T136777A22032828.en>

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Taxonomy

Kingdom	Phylum	Class	Order	Family
Animalia	Chordata	Mammalia	Chiroptera	Natalidae

Taxon Name: *Natalus primus* Anthony, 1919

Common Name(s):

- English: Cuban Greater Funnel-eared Bat

Taxonomic Notes:

This species was formerly included in *N. stramineus*, but is clearly distinct from that species; see Morgan (1989), Morgan and Czaplewski (2003) and Simmons (2005).

Assessment Information

Red List Category & Criteria: Vulnerable D2 [ver 3.1](#)

Year Published: 2016

Date Assessed: October 21, 2014

Justification:

This species is listed as Vulnerable because it is only known from a single cave (and therefore, one location), with an area of occupancy (AOO) under 20 km², and with a continuing decline in the extent and quality of its habitat that might result in the taxon becoming Critically Endangered or Extinct in a very short time.

Previously Published Red List Assessments

2008 – Critically Endangered (CR) – <http://dx.doi.org/10.2305/IUCN.UK.2008.RLTS.T136777A4338583.en>

Geographic Range

Range Description:

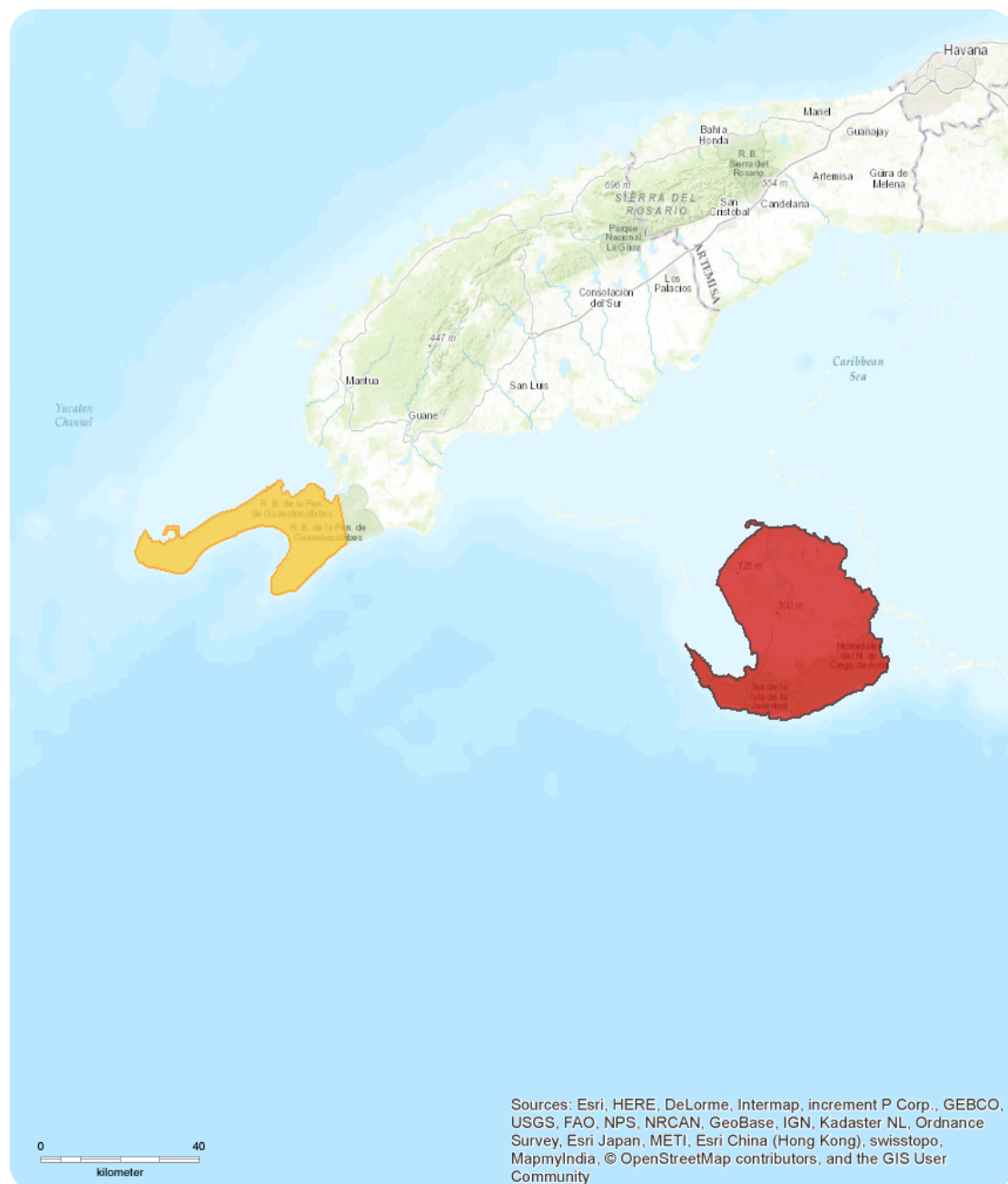
Rediscovered in 1992, this species was previously thought to be extinct. A recent subpopulation of this species is known from one cave on the western tip of Cuba (Tejedor *et al.* 2004, Mancina 2012), but fossils occur at several sites on Cuba and the Isla de Pinos (Silva Taboada 1979).

Country Occurrence:

Native: Cuba

Distribution Map

Natalus primus



Range

- Extant (resident)
- Extinct

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Conservation of Nature)



The boundaries and names shown and the designations used on this map do not imply any official endorsement, acceptance or opinion by IUCN.



Population

This species is known from a single cave, probably including a few thousand individuals (Tejedor *et al.* 2005). Fossil remains suggest a former wider distribution throughout Cuba and Isla de Pinos (Silva-Taboada 1979), the Bahamas and Cayman Islands (Tejedor 2011).

Current Population Trend: Decreasing

Habitat and Ecology (see Appendix for additional information)

This species roosts in caves. It is known from a single cave (Tejedor *et al.* 2005). This species is moderately to highly gregarious with cave colonies estimated at fewer than 100 individuals (Tejedor *et al.* 2005). Copulation in *N. primus* has been observed to take place in April, and pregnant females of this species have been captured in May (Tejedor *et al.* 2004). It has been found to feed mostly on moths, crickets and beetles, and less frequently on other insect orders: Hymenoptera (*Formicidae*), Neuroptera, Diptera, Homoptera and Hemiptera (Tejedor *et al.* 2004).

Systems: Terrestrial

Use and Trade

This species is not used.

Threats (see Appendix for additional information)

Habitat loss and human intrusion in the cave are the main threats (Tejedor *et al.* 2004, Mancina 2012). In addition the ongoing collapse of the roof of the cave can upset the thermal balance in this hot cave. Climatic changes could also interrupt the thermal cave balance and result in extinction of this species (L. Dávalos pers. comm.)

Conservation Actions (see Appendix for additional information)

Protecting the cave is the most important priority, this must include limitation of access by non-authorized personnel (Tejedor *et al.* 2004, Mancina 2012).

Credits

Assessor(s): Mancina, C.

Reviewer(s): Solari, S.

Contributor(s): Dávalos, L.

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External Resources

For [Images and External Links to Additional Information](#), please see the [Red List website](#).

Appendix

Habitats

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Habitat	Season	Suitability	Major Importance?
7. Caves and Subterranean Habitats (non-aquatic) -> 7.1. Caves and Subterranean Habitats (non-aquatic) - Caves	-	Suitable	Yes

Threats

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Threat	Timing	Scope	Severity	Impact Score
10. Geological events -> 10.3. Avalanches/landslides	Ongoing	-	-	-
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.1. Ecosystem conversion 1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance		
11. Climate change & severe weather -> 11.3. Temperature extremes	Ongoing	-	-	-
	Stresses:	1. Ecosystem stresses -> 1.2. Ecosystem degradation 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality 2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance		
6. Human intrusions & disturbance -> 6.1. Recreational activities	Ongoing	-	-	-
	Stresses:	2. Species Stresses -> 2.2. Species disturbance		

Conservation Actions in Place

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Conservation Actions in Place
In-Place Land/Water Protection and Management
Occur in at least one PA: No

Conservation Actions Needed

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Conservation Actions Needed
1. Land/water protection -> 1.1. Site/area protection
2. Land/water management -> 2.1. Site/area management
4. Education & awareness -> 4.3. Awareness & communications

Research Needed

(<http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes>)

Research Needed
1. Research -> 1.3. Life history & ecology
1. Research -> 1.5. Threats
3. Monitoring -> 3.1. Population trends

Additional Data Fields

Distribution
Continuing decline in area of occupancy (AOO): Yes
Estimated extent of occurrence (EOO) (km ²): 13324
Number of Locations: 1
Population
Continuing decline of mature individuals: Yes
Population severely fragmented: No
Habitats and Ecology
Movement patterns: Nomadic

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